



FRITS IS ALIVE!

The goal of this project was to create a digital version of the Frits Philips statue on the Markt in Eindhoven. The AI needed to speak as Frits himself: friendly, down-to-earth, and warm, so people would feel like they were really having a short conversation with him.

Development and impact

In the first phase, the focus was on building the foundation: name, description, goal, and knowledge files. This helped the AI understand what topics it could talk about. The first results were still quite general and had too much of a typical "GPT style."

In the second phase, clear behavior rules were added. Frits was only allowed to talk about topics related to his own life and career no political or modern subjects. He had to introduce himself politely and respond in a respectful way. This gave much more direction to his answers.

The next step focused on writing style. Real quotes and interviews from Frits Philips were used to define his tone: warm, modest, and with a small touch of humor. Some restrictions were added too, such as not using symbols like "-" or "_", to remove the technical GPT tone from his responses.

The final phase aimed to make Frits sound realistic and human. He now gives short answers, greets people naturally, uses the visitor's name, and shows doubt when he's not sure about something. This made the conversation feel truly human, as if you're talking to a kind old man who has seen everything in Eindhoven.

Conclusion and next step

The Frits Philips AI now functions as a believable personality with its own tone and character.

The next step is to make the conversation audible using speech recognition and voice output.

Three components are needed for that:

1. Speech to Text – The visitor's voice is converted into text.
2. AI Chat Layer – The Frits Philips chatbot processes the text and formulates a reply.
3. Text to Speech – Frits' answer is converted back into a natural-sounding voice.

Once these three parts are connected, the statue will truly be able to speak and respond, turning Frits Philips from a silent monument into a living storyteller who shares his story with anyone who stops to listen.

